

Nouns

NOUNS ARE USED TO NAME PEOPLE, ANIMALS, PLACES, OR THINGS.

Nouns are often known as “naming” words. Every sentence must include at least one noun or pronoun. Most nouns can be either singular or plural, and can be divided into two main groups: common and proper nouns.

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Common nouns (concrete)

Common nouns are used all the time to describe everyday objects, animals, places, people, and ideas. They do not have a capital letter unless they appear at the start of a sentence. Every sentence must contain a noun, and this noun is usually a common noun. Common nouns that describe things that can be seen and touched are known as concrete nouns.

book goat bread birds girl piece

Common nouns (abstract)

A type of common noun, abstract nouns are more difficult to define. Unlike concrete nouns, which refer to physical things, abstract nouns refer to ideas, feelings, occasions, or time—things that can't be seen or touched.

love happiness trust
bravery
afternoon health

The **goat's** **afternoon** was ruined down and snatched the **piece** of



- With the exception of some abstract nouns, if the word **the** can be put **in front of a word** and the resulting combination **makes sense**, then that word is a **noun**.
- Nouns can often be recognized by their **endings**. Typical endings include **-er**, **-or**, **-ist**, **-tion**, **-ment**, and **-ism**: *writer, visitor, dentist, competition, argument, criticism*.

GLOSSARY

Abstract noun The name given to something that cannot be touched, such as a concept or a sensation.

Collective noun The name given to a collection of individuals—people or things.

Concrete noun The name given to an ordinary thing, such as an animal or object.

Noun phrase Several words that, when grouped together, perform the same function as a noun.

Proper noun The name given to a particular person, place, or thing, which always starts with a capital letter.

Prepositional phrase A preposition such as *in* or *on* followed by a noun or pronoun that together act as an adjective (describing a noun) or an adverb (describing a verb) in a sentence.